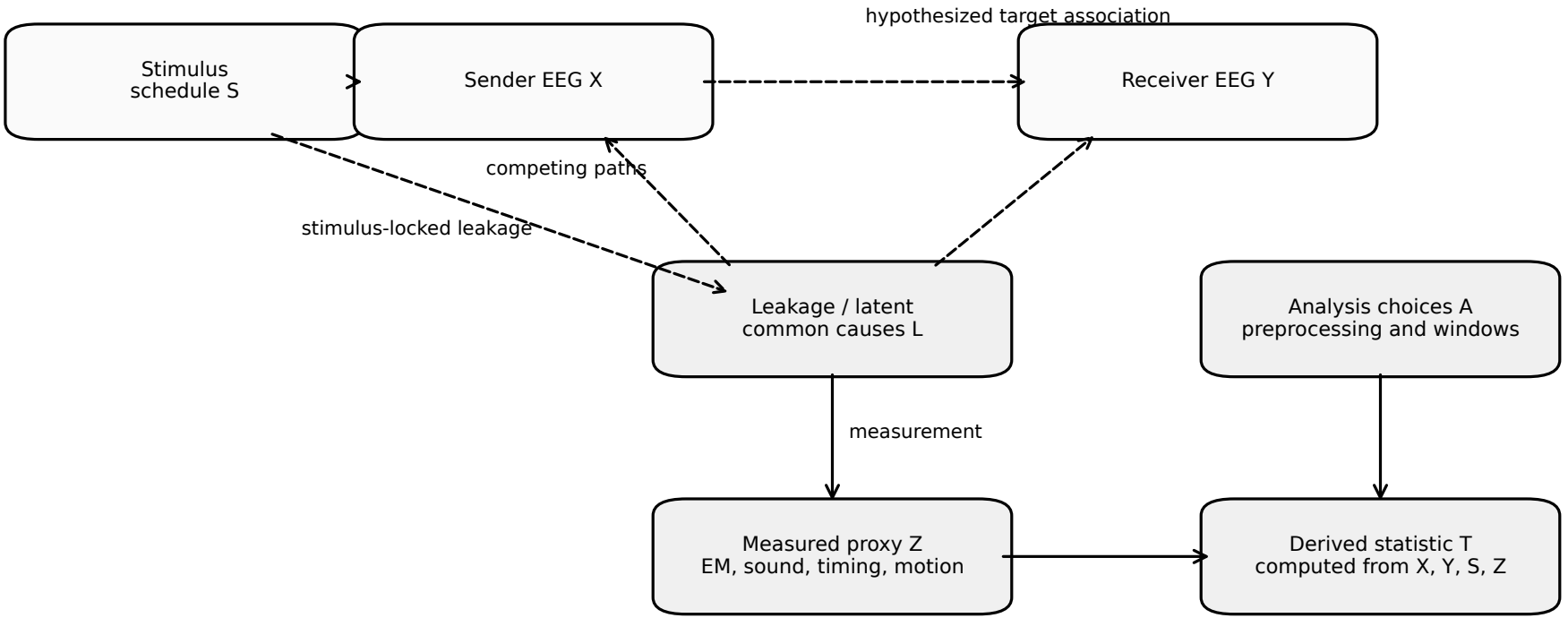
Causal hypotheses, measurement proxies, and analysis choices must not be conflated.



Dashed edges mark hypothesized or competing paths. Controls constrain alternatives only when measured and linked to the analysis.